

PRACTICAL PRAYERS

Thirty Trika prayers for the moments of the day

WAKING · BATHING · SOCIAL · WORK · FOOD · WAITING · NEGATIVE · POSITIVE · EVENING

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम्

the offering is brahman, the oblation is brahman,
poured by brahman into the fire of brahman

BHAGAVAD GĪTĀ 4.24 — THE MEAL PRAYER

How this book works Nine sections, one for each turn of the day. Every prayer faces its explanation: the prayer page is for the mouth, the guide page for the mind. Take the prayer at the moment it names — before food, at the threshold, when the negativity arrives — and read its guide once, so the words land with their logic. All seventy-two prayers are Trika: Kashmir Shaivism's own corpus, from Abhinavagupta and Utpaladeva to Vasugupta, Kṣemarāja, Somananda, and the anonymous masters of the Vijñāna Bhairava and the Dehastha. Nothing here needs belief. The verses were built to be said — at the sink, at the desk, in the queue, in the dark.

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I

Waking / Morning

on rising

Homage to the World-Formed

प्रपञ्चोत्तीर्णरूपाय नमस्ते विश्वमूर्तये ।

सदादिव्यप्रकाशाय

स्वात्मनेऽनन्तशक्तये

prapañcottīrṇarūpāya namaste viśvamūrtaye | sadādivyaprakāśāya svātmane'nantaśaktaye

homage to the form that has crossed beyond the manifest — to the self of the world's form; to the ever-divinely-shining, to the self that is unending power.

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Homage to the World-Formed

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.1 · V.1

The first word of the day: bowing to what was here before you woke.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Three appositions do the work: he has passed beyond the manifest yet IS the world's form; he always shines with divine light; he is your own self and consists of inexhaustible power. The logic is identity, not distance — you salute the world-form because you address what already shines.

HOW TO USE IT

Sitting up before your feet touch the floor. Three clauses, three slow bows of the head. Feel the room as svātmane'nantaśaktaye — not out there but as your own body's brightness. Don't visualise a figure; visualise light that has nowhere to go. One round, then stand.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.1

The Body-Temple Offering

देहो देवालयः प्रोक्तः स्वात्मा देवः सनातनः । त्यजेदज्ञाननिर्माल्यं सोऽहं भावेन पूजयेत्

deho devālayaḥ proktaḥ svātmā devaḥ sanātanaḥ | tyajedajñānanirmālyaṃ so'haṃ bhāvena pūjayet

the body is declared god's temple, the own self the eternal god. casting off the sweepings of ignorance, let him worship with the feeling: i-am-he.

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The Body-Temple Offering

DEHASTHA V.1 · V.1

The morning rite in one verse: the body is the shrine, so'ham is the worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Dehastha compresses a whole pūjā into four clauses. Temple, God, sweeping, worship: a temple needs cleaning before its God is honoured, and the 'sweepings of ignorance' are the ordinary assumption that the body is mere matter. The worshipper and the worshipped collapse — so'ham bhāvena, with the feeling I-am-He.

HOW TO USE IT

Wake and stay horizontal. Sweep an imaginary hand from head to toe three times — that is casting off the sweepings. Then place attention at the heart and let so'haṃ, so'haṃ rest with the breath for twelve rounds. The feeling: warmth at the chest, not a thought — the body as lit. Then rise: the day is the pūjā.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.1

The Three States as His Rays

जाग्रतस्वप्नसुषुप्त्याद्या धारयंश्च निजाः कलाः ।
स्वेच्छया भासि नटवन् निष्कलोऽसि च तत्त्वतः

jāgratasvapnasuṣuptyādyā dhārayaṃśca nijāḥ kalāḥ | svecchayā bhāsi naṭavan niṣkalo'si ca tattvataḥ

waking, dreaming, deep sleep and the rest — you hold them as your own portions. By your will you shine like an actor, yet you are partless in truth.

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The Three States as His Rays

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.10 · V.10

The three states are costumes; the one who shines is partless.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse splits experience from experiencer: the states are kalāḥ, portions or costumes — things held; the holding is by svecchā, your own will; and the actor is partless though he plays many parts. Play and partlessness are asserted in one breath, so no state can claim you.

HOW TO USE IT

Recite on waking, naming each state as you come out of it: 'that was a costume.' The actor-idea is literal — you played sleep for seven hours. Feel the partlessness as the fact that nothing about you has edges. Keep it memorised: the fastest exit from a bad dream.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.10

Wake the Knowledge That Frees

जयन्त्य्
अपारसंसारसारासारविभागदाः ।
कैवल्यज्ञानसंबोधहेतवश् शम्भवाङ्घ्रयः

jayanty apārasaṃsārasārāsāravibhāgadāḥ | kaivalyajñānasaṃbodhahetavaś śambhavāṅghrayaḥ

victorious are śambhu's feet — they that tell the endless wheel of becoming from its essence and its refuse, and are the cause of the waking knowledge that frees.

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Wake the Knowledge That Frees

SVABODHASIDDHI V.4 · V.4

A dawn verse whose whole grammar is waking.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Three functions stacked on the feet: they discriminate (saṃsāra's sāra against asāra — essence against refuse), they cause the knowledge that awakens (saṃbodhi-hetu), and they are victorious. Liberation is not granted but caused — through a knowledge that must wake, exactly like you.

HOW TO USE IT

Say it once after the body-temple verse. Weight the word saṃbodha — waking. Picture a lamp being lit rather than a person bowing. Feel-test: does the line make the room sharper? Repeat at any hour when you have been awake but not waking.

Source: L2-svab-p01.md · v.4

Waking, Dreaming, and the Fourth

जाग्रद् विश्वं भेदात् स्वप्नस् तेजः प्रकाशमाहात्म्यात् । प्राज्ञः सुप्तावस्था ज्ञानघनत्वात् ततः परं तुर्यम्

jāgrad viśvaṃ bhedāt svapnas tejaḥ prakāśamāhātmyāt | prājñaḥ suptāvasthā jñānaghanatvāt tataḥ paraṃ turyam

waking is the universe, through difference; dreaming is splendour, through the greatness of light; the knower is the state of sleep, through the massing of knowing; beyond that, the fourth.

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Waking, Dreaming, and the Fourth

PARAMĀRTHASĀRA V.35 · V.35

Abhinavagupta's census of the states — each credited with what it does best.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Each state is honoured for its real contribution instead of being ranked: waking gives the many, dream gives light, sleep gives massed knowing. Only then is turya named — beyond the three, not as a fourth state but as what was never covered by them. The census dismantles the hierarchy.

HOW TO USE IT

A morning inventory: touch each clause with a memory — this room, that dream, that blankness. Stop at tataḥ paraṃ turyam and don't try to produce a fourth; the verse says beyond, not within. Feeling-tip: after the third clause leave a half-beat of silence — that gap is closer to turya than any image.

Source: L2-param-p04.md · v.35

The Play of the Dawning

उदयावभासचर्वणलीलां विश्वस्य या करोत्यनिशम्। आनन्दभैरवीं तां विमर्शरूपामहं वन्दे

udayāvabhāsacarvaṇalīlāṃ viśvasya yā karotyaniśam | ānandabhairavīṃ tāṃ vimarśarūpāmahaṃ vande

the play of the dawning, shining forth, and chewing over of the universe, which she performs unceasingly — bliss-bhairavī, her, whose form is reflection, i praise.

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The Play of the Dawning

DEHASTHA V.6 · V.6

The dawn is her play: she chews the universe into light, unceasingly.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Bhairavī's līlā is udaya-avabhāsa-carvaṇa — the dawning, shining and chewing of the universe, performed without pause; her form is vimarśa, reflective awareness. The morning light is not physics but her appetite: she is already chewing the day into being when you open your eyes.

HOW TO USE IT

At first light, before anything else: watch the room brighten and name it her chewing. One line. Feeling-tip: the day is being eaten into existence for you; you arrive mid-meal. Gratitude, not effort.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.6

Bow to the Giver of Freedom

नमः सकलकल्याणमयकैवल्यदायिने /

शिवाय

शमिताशेषभवाध्वध्वान्तभानवे

namaḥ sakalakalyāṇamayakaivalyadāyine / śivāya śamitāśeṣabhavādhvadhvāntabhānave

bow to the giver of freedom, made of every blessing — to śiva, the sun that burnt away the darkness on every road of becoming.

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Bow to the Giver of Freedom

SVABODHASIDDHI V.1 · V.1

A morning bow to the sun that burns the roads dark.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse stacks blessings — sakalakalyāṇa-maya, made of every good — with the one gift that matters, kaivalya, freedom, and calls Śiva the light that has already burnt the darkness on every path of becoming. You don't light the road at dawn; you bow to the one who burned it.

HOW TO USE IT

At the window, sun on the face: one bow, palms together. The darkness on the road is already burnt — say it as fact, not wish. Feeling-tip: the day's route looks pre-cleared; you're just walking it.

Source: L2-svab-p01.md · v.1

The Mudrā of the Waking Hour

अन्तर्लक्ष्यविलीनचित्तपवनो योगी यदा वर्तते दृष्ट्या निश्चलतारया बहिरसौ पश्यन्नपश्यन्नपि । मुद्रेयं खलु शाम्भवी भवति सा युष्मत्प्रसादाद्गुरो शून्याशून्यविवर्जितं भवति यत् तत्त्वं पदं शाम्भवम्

antarlakṣyavilīnacittapavano yogī yadā vartate dṛṣṭyā niścalatārayā bahirasau paśyannapaśyannapi | mudreyaṃ khalu śāmbhavī bhavati sā yuṣmatprasādādguro śūnyāśūnyavivarjitaṃ bhavati yat tattvaṃ padaṃ śāmbhavam

when the yogin abides with mind-wind dissolved in the inward aim — he, seeing yet not seeing outside with unmoving-pupil gaze — this indeed becomes the śāmbhavī mudrā, by your grace, o guru: devoid of void and non-void becomes that reality, the śāmbhava state.

The Mudrā of the Waking Hour

ANUBHAVANIVEDANA V.1 · ANU-P01 V.1

Half-awake, seeing-not-seeing: the first mudrā of the day.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse catches the yogin at the waking edge: the mind-wind dissolved inward, pupils steady, seeing the outside yet not seeing it — paśyan apaśyan. That in-between is the śāmbhavī mudrā, and the state it opens is beyond even void and non-void. The hypnopompic moment is already the practice.

HOW TO USE IT

In bed, eyes half-open before rising: hold one minute in seeing-not-seeing. Don't grasp the state; the verse only names where you already are. Feeling-tip: the room is visible and not-yet-real; stay a breath longer than comfortable.

Source: anubhavanivedana.md · anu-p01 v.1

II

Bathing

water & body

Whence Foot-Water?

पूर्णस्यावाहनं कुत्र सर्वाधारस्य चासनम्। स्वच्छस्य पाद्यमर्घ्यञ्च शुद्धस्याचमनं कुतः

pūrṇasyāvāhanaṃ kutra sarvādhārasya cāsanam | svacchasya pādyamarghyañca śuddhasyācamanaṃ kutaḥ

for the full, whence invocation? for the all-supporting, whence a seat? for the clear, foot-water and welcome-water? for the pure, the sipping?

Whence Foot-Water?

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.13 · V.13

The litany begins at the washbasin: the rites cannot apply to what already contains them.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The first questions of the deconstructive litany: āvāhana (invocation) presumes absence, āsana (seat) presumes sitting elsewhere, pādyārghya (foot- and hand-water) presumes a journey, ācamana (sipping) presumes impurity. Śiva lacks nothing and is never impure — so the washing is for you, not him. The recognition is a perfect absence of need.

HOW TO USE IT

At the basin, water on the hands: let each 'whence?' land as a shrug. The water is real, the impurity imagined, the washing both. Feeling-tip: lightness, not solemnity — the joke is the doctrine, and the hands are clean either way.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.13

What Bath for the Stainless?

निर्मलस्य कुतः स्नानं वस्त्रं विश्वोदरस्य च। निर्लेपस्य कुतो गन्धो रम्यस्याभरणं कुतः

nirmalasya kutaḥ snānaṃ vastraṃ viśvodarasya ca | nirlepasya kuto gandho ramyasyābharaṇaṃ kutaḥ

for the stainless, what bath? for the world-bellied, what garment? for the unanointed, what scent? for the lovely, what jewel?

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What Bath for the Stainless?

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.14 · V.14

Shower, towel, scent, jewel — all addressed to one who needs none.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The litany names the bathroom itself: snāna (bath), vastra (garment), gandha (scent), bharaṇa (jewel) — each with a deity stripped of the lack it serves: stainless, world-bellied (all-containing), unanointed, lovely. What looks like futility is the precise applicability of each gift: you bathe the unblemished because bathing is what love does, not what dirt requires.

HOW TO USE IT

In the shower: name each item as you use it — water for the stainless, towel for the world-bellied, scent for the unanointed. The mismatch is the smile. Feeling-tip: the water becomes an offering rather than a chore; three items, three small bows.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.14

Flowers for the Desireless

निरालम्बस्योपवीतं पुष्पं निर्वासनस्य च । अघ्राणस्य कुतो धूपश्चक्षुर्हीनस्य दीपकः

nirālambasyopavītaṃ puṣpaṃ nirvāsanasya ca | aghrāṇasya kuto dhūpaścakṣurhīnasya dīpakaḥ

the sacred thread for the supportless, flowers for the desireless; incense for the noseless, lamp for the eyeless — of what use?

Flowers for the Desireless

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.15 · V.15

At the mirror: thread, flower, incense, lamp — for the one who has none of the faculties they serve.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The next movement of the litany names the offering-objects — upavīta (thread), puṣpa (flower), dhūpa (incense), dīpaka (lamp) — each matched to a deity stripped of the relevant faculty: no support, no desire, no nose, no eye. The mismatch is the teaching: worship addresses the emptiness of lack itself. What looks like futility is the exact fit of each gift.

HOW TO USE IT

At the mirror or altar: offer each item while naming its mismatch — thread for the one who supports nothing, incense for the one with no nose. With no altar, do it in air with the hand: four gestures, four lines. The feeling: tenderness toward an absence rather than a presence.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.15

The Stainless Guru

यद्धीबलेन विश्वं भक्तानां शिवपथं भाति । तमहमवधानरूपं सद्गुरुममलं सदा वन्दे

yaddhībalena viśvaṃ bhaktānāṃ śivapathaṃ bhāti | tamahamavadhānarūpaṃ sadgurumamalaṃ sadā vande

by whose mind-strength the universe shines as śiva's path for devotees — him, intent in attention, the stainless true guru, always i praise.

The Stainless Guru

DEHASTHA V.4 · V.4

After the water: the guru is attention itself, made stainless.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse identifies the guru not primarily as a person but as avadhāna-rūpa — the form of intent attention — by whose dhībala (mind-strength) the whole universe shines as Śiva's path for devotees. The guru is what makes the world a road rather than a mess. The stainless one (amala) mirrors the freshly washed body.

HOW TO USE IT

Towel in hand, after the bath: one bow to the clarity that is seeing — the attention that has just been rinsed into readiness. Feeling-tip: the room looks slightly sharper; that sharpness is the guru's path appearing. Then dress as devotee on that path.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.4

This Body for Worship

अन्तरुल्लसदच्छाच्छभक्तिपीयूषपोषितम् / भवत्पूजोपयोगाय शरीरम् इदम् अस्तु मे

antarullasadacchācchabhaktipīyūṣapoṣitam / bhavatpūjopayogāya śarīram idam astu me

may this body of mine — nourished by the clear, bright nectar of devotion rising within — be fit only for your worship.

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This Body for Worship

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.26 · 17.26

The body leaves the water consecrated: today's uniform is worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The body is not renounced; it is consecrated. Nourished by the clear nectar of devotion rising in the heart (antar ullasad acchāccha-bhakti-pīyūṣa), it becomes fit for pūjā — and then it is the offering itself. This is the Trika answer to body-denial: the body is the Lord's instrument, and devotion makes it luminous.

HOW TO USE IT

Dressed, before leaving the bathroom: say it once and feel the freshly washed body as anointed rather than merely clean. The day ahead is the pūjā; the body is the instrument. Feeling-tip: a slight uprightness in the spine — the instrument picking itself up.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.26

Waving-Lights for the Self-Shining

स्वयं प्रकाशमानस्य कुतो नीराजनं विभोः । वेदवाचामवेद्यस्य कुतः स्तोत्रं विधीयते

svayaṃ prakāśamānasya kuto nīrājanaṃ vibhoḥ | vedavācāmavedyasya kutaḥ stotraṃ vidhīyate

whence waving-lights for the self-shining lord? how is a hymn enjoined for him whom the veda cannot say?

Waving-Lights for the Self-Shining

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.17 · V.17

The mirror, the lamp: he lights himself — so the light is for you.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Two paradoxes: an offering of light presupposes darkness in the recipient; speech presupposes an object speech can reach. The Lord is self-lit and beyond the Veda's words. The rite's use falls on the offerer — you wave the lamp so your own eyes open; you sing because the singing lights you.

HOW TO USE IT

At the bathroom mirror, hand raised with the light: you are the lamp-bearer, and the face that brightens is the audience. Hum, don't articulate — you have just honoured the Vedavācāmavedya. Feeling-tip: the chest brightens before the mirror does.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.17

Oblation for the Difference-Free

अन्तर्बहिश्च पूर्णस्य कथमुद्वासनं भवेत् । भेदहीनस्य विश्वत्र कथं च हवनं भवेत्

antarbahiśca pūrṇasya kathamudvāsanaṃ bhavet | bhedahīnasya viśvatra kathaṃ ca havanaṃ bhavet

how is there sending-off for the full, inside and out? and how is there oblation for the difference-free, everywhere?

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Oblation for the Difference-Free

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.18 · V.18

You can't send off or burn what's already everywhere.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Udvāsana (formal dismissal) and havana (oblation into fire) both require edges — a thing to dismiss, a thing to burn. The full has no inside or out; the difference-free is everywhere, so nothing can be offered into a fire that isn't already him. The washing has no residue to send away.

HOW TO USE IT

At the end of the bath, hand under the tap: the water dismisses nothing and burns nothing; it just falls. Let the litany's answer be that shrug. Feeling-tip: no residue to send off — the day starts clean because it was never stained.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.18

Pardon for the Unseen

पूर्णस्य दक्षिणा कुत्र नित्यतृप्तस्य तर्पणम्। विसर्जनं व्यापकस्याऽप्रत्यक्षस्य क्षमापणम्

pūrṇasya dakṣiṇā kutra nityatṛptasya tarpaṇam | visarjanaṃ vyāpakasyā'pratyakṣasya kṣamāpaṇam

where is the fee for the full? libation for the ever-content? dismissal for the all-pervading? pardon for the unseen?

Pardon for the Unseen

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.19 · V.19

The ritual closes with forgiveness — and no account to settle.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The four closing rites: dakṣiṇā (fee), tarpaṇa (libation), visarjana (dismissal), kṣamāpaṇa (apology for faults) — all presuppose want, debt, departure and fault in one who is full, content, all-pervading and unseen. The kṣamāpaṇa for the apratyakṣa flips apology into recognition: you apologise to what was never absent.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it at the end of the bath as the day's closing already: one bow, weight the last word — pardon. The feeling is the end of accounting: no tally of errors, no debt. Guilt arrives, is named as one of the litany's items, and dissolves with the god it expected to offend.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.19

III

Social

out among people

Gaṇapati at the Threshold

असुरसुरवृन्दवन्दितमभिमतवरवितरणे निरतम्। दर्शनशताग्र्यपूज्यं प्राणतनुं गणपतिं वन्दे

asurasuravṛndavanditamabhimatavaravitaraṇe niratam | darśanaśatāgryapūjyaṃ prāṇatanuṃ gaṇapatiṃ vande

him who is saluted by the hosts of demons and gods, engaged in bestowing wished-for boons, worshipable as foremost in a hundred rites, breath-bodied — gaṇapati i praise.

Gaṇapati at the Threshold

DEHASTHA V.2 · V.2

The Trika Gaṇeśa: breath-bodied, praised by gods and demons alike.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Dehastha names Gaṇapati as prāṇatanu — breath-bodied — not as a distant remover of obstacles but as the breath itself, busy granting boons. The one who salutes him includes demons and gods, so the blessing does not discriminate. The verse turns the threshold into a court where everyone waits.

HOW TO USE IT

At the door, before stepping out: one round, hand on the chest. Feel the breath as Gaṇapati already granting the day's boons. The feeling: the obstacle is not outside the door — it is the contraction you carry through it; the breath loosens it. Then walk.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.2

The Thunderbolt Path

सर्वाशङ्कासनिं सर्वालक्ष्मीकालानलं तथा / सर्वामङ्गल्यकल्पान्तं मार्गं माहेश्वरं नुमः

sarvāśaṅkāsaniṃ sarvālakṣmīkālānalaṃ tathā / sarvāmaṅgalyakalpāntaṃ mārgaṃ māheśvaraṃ numaḥ

to the path of maheśvara — shattering every doubt, burning every misfortune like the fire of time, the fulfilment of every good fortune — namas.

The Thunderbolt Path

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.28 · 2.28

For the road: a path that burns what's in the way.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Lakshmanjoo's gloss: the path is a thunderbolt that shatters doubts; alakṣmī (misfortune) is daridhratā, poverty of spirit, and the path fires it to ashes like kālāgnirudra; kalpa's end comes so joy arrives. The verse is a blessing on the way itself — not safe travel but a road that works on you as you walk it.

HOW TO USE IT

Before leaving: say it once, facing the direction you're going. The image is a burning path — not destructive but consuming of what shouldn't arrive with you. Feeling-tip: the first few steps feel lighter; that's the alakṣmī left at the door.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.28

The Speech-Goddess

स्वात्मप्रभां विधाय वाग्देवीं विषयकुसुमकॢप्तार्चः । प्रथमोन्मेषं गुरुम् अथ वन्दित्वा हृदयम् आविश्य

svātmaprabhāṃ vidhāya vāgdevīṃ viṣayakusumakḷptārcaḥ | prathamonmeṣaṃ gurum atha vanditvā hṛdayam āviśya

having made the speech-goddess one's own light, with sense-flowers arranged as offering — bowing to the guru, first unfolding, then entering the heart.

The Speech-Goddess

BHAIRAVĀNUKARAṆA V.7 · BHAIR-P01 V.7

Before you speak: make vāk the light, not the weapon.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse sequences the art of speech: svātmaprabhāṃ vidhāya vāgdevīṃ — make the speech-goddess your own light; arrange the sense-flowers as the offering; bow to the guru, the first unfolding (prathamonmeṣa); then enter the heart. Speech is not emitted from the mouth but lit from the heart and offered with the senses.

HOW TO USE IT

Before a difficult conversation, a speech, a message you'll regret: one breath, hand on the throat. Make the speech a light — not a blade. Offering the sense-flowers means: don't weaponise what you've seen and heard. Then speak from the heart-entered place, not the throat.

Source: bhairavanukarana.md · bhair-p01 v.7

Every Sound Is Mantra

शब्दः कश्चन यो मुखादुदयते मन्त्रः स लोकोत्तरः संस्थानं सुखदुःखजन्मवपुषो यत्कापि मुद्रैव सा। प्राणस्य स्वरसेन यत्प्रवहणं योगः स एवाद्भुतः शाक्तं धाम परं ममानुभवतः किन्नाम न भ्राजते

śabdaḥ kaścana yo mukhādudayate mantraḥ sa lokottaraḥ saṃsthānaṃ sukhaduḥkhajanmavapuṣo yatkāpi mudraiva sā | prāṇasya svarasena yatpravahaṇaṃ yogaḥ sa evādbhutaḥ śāktaṃ dhāma paraṃ mamānubhavataḥ kinnāma na bhrājate

whatever sound arises from the mouth — that mantra is transcendent. whatever posture of the pleasure-pain-born body — that indeed is mudrā. whatever flowing of breath by its own rhythm — that indeed is wonderful yoga. the supreme śākta abode — while i experience, what indeed would not shine?

Every Sound Is Mantra

ANUBHAVANIVEDANA V.3 · ANU-P03 V.3

Every word out of your mouth is already a mantra. Use that.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Abhinavagupta's experience-report: any sound from the mouth is lokottara mantra — transcendent; any posture is mudrā; any breath-flow by its own rhythm is yoga. Nothing needs to be Sanskritic to be practice. The verse abolishes the distinction between talking and chanting, fidgeting and ritual, breathing and kriyā.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it after you've said something — ordinary, even stupid. That was mantra. The recognition flips the whole day: the meeting, the small talk, the complaint — all of it is mantra, mudrā, yoga, shining. Feeling-tip: the mouth becomes a temple; be careful what you put on the altar.

Source: anubhavanivedana.md · anu-p03 v.3

Enough of Difference-Talk

अलं भेदानुकथया त्वद्भक्तिरसचर्वणात् । सर्वमेकमिदं शान्तमिति वक्तुं च लज्जते

alaṃ bhedānukathayā tvadbhaktirasacarvaṇāt | sarvamekamidaṃ śāntamiti vaktuṃ ca lajjate

enough of difference-talk — chewing the sap of devotion to you: all this is one, at peace; and even to say so feels shy.

Enough of Difference-Talk

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.8 · V.8

Knowing when to stop talking: the oneness embarrasses speech.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Bheda-anukathā, the narration of difference, is abandoned mid-chewing of bhakti-rasa: all is one, at peace. And even to say so feels shy (lajjate) — the verse guards non-duality from becoming a thesis. The oneness is so ordinary that stating it out loud is like announcing a family is at peace: true, and slightly vulgar.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it when an argument about views has you mid-sentence — or when you're about to explain your practice to someone who doesn't need it. Stop. The shyness is the right register. Feeling-tip: looking away slightly, a small heat in the face — let the body do the disarming.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.8

Vaṭuka at the Door

वरवीरयोगिनीगणसिद्धावलिपूजिताङ्घ्रियुगल

। अपहृतविनयिजनार्तिं

वटुकमपानाभिधं वन्दे

varavīrayoginīgaṇasiddhāvalipūjitāṅghriyugalam / apahṛtavinayijanārtiṃ vaṭukamapānābhidhaṃ vande

whose foot-pair is worshipped by choice heroes, troops of yoginīs, rows of perfected ones; who removes the pain of humble folk — vaṭuka, named apāna, i praise.

Vaṭuka at the Door

DEHASTHA V.3 · V.3

The guardian at the threshold: the breath that clears the way.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Vaṭuka is identified with apāna — the lower breath that rules elimination and grounding. His feet are worshipped by heroes, yoginīs and perfected ones, yet his special work is removing the pain of the humble. The power that clears the body's waste also clears the road ahead.

HOW TO USE IT

Standing at the threshold: one breath pushed down toward the feet — that is apāna doing Vaṭuka's work. Say the verse once. Feeling-tip: the soles warm slightly; the ground answers. Anything that doesn't go with you — let it be removed here.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.3

When Your Words Are Not Heard

ब्रूषे नोत्तमाङ्ग पश्यसि न मामेतादृशं दुःखितं विज्ञप्तिं बहुधा कृतां न शृणुषे नायासि मन्मानसे । संसारार्णवगर्तमध्यपतितं प्रायेण नालम्बसे वाक्चक्षुःश्रवणाङ्घ्रिणादिरहितं त्वामाह सत्यं श्रुतिः

brūṣe nottamāṅga paśyasi na māmetādṛśaṃ duḥkhitaṃ vijñaptiṃ bahudhā kṛtāṃ na śṛṇuṣe nāyāsi manmānase | saṃsārārṇavagartamadhyapatitaṃ prāyeṇa nālambase vākcakṣuḥśravaṇāṅghriṇādirahitaṃ tvāmāha satyaṃ śrutiḥ

you speak not, o best-limbed one; you look not upon me, wretched as i am. my entreaty, made in many ways, you hear not; you come not into my mind. fallen amid the pit of the ocean of transmigration, i am mostly left unsupported — yet scripture truly declares you devoid of speech, sight, hearing, feet and the like!

THE GUIDE

When Your Words Are Not Heard

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 3 · PAN-P03

The complaint: you don't speak, look or hear — and scripture says you can't. Ouch.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Pañcaślokī 3 is the reproach: the devotee accuses Śiva of silence — no speech, no glance, no listening, no arrival in the mind — then undercuts himself with scripture's own claim that the Lord is devoid of speech, sight, hearing and feet. The complaint and the theology cancel: you're angry at a god who, by definition, never had a mouth to answer with.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it when you've spoken and nobody heard — human or divine. Say the whole complaint with feeling; the scripture-clause at the end is the punchline that dissolves it. Feeling-tip: the irritation turns to laughter mid-verse; that laugh is the prasāda.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p03

The Finesse of Going

एतद्वचननैपुण्यं यत्कर्तव्येतिमूलया ।
भवन्मायात्मनस्तस्य केन कस्मिन् कुतो
लयः

etadgacananaipuṇyaṃ yatkartavyetimūlayā | bhavanmāyātmanastasya kena kasmin kuto layaḥ

what finesse of going is there, what should be done, thus, from the root? of yours, made of your magic power — by what, in what, from where is the dissolving?

The Finesse of Going

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.5 · V.5

The going itself is his magic; the planner is dismissed before the step.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse asks from the root: what is the skill of going, what must be done — and answers that the whole movement is bhavanmāyātmana, made of your magic power. Going and dissolving are not yours to engineer; they happen by his māyā. The question dismantles the planner.

HOW TO USE IT

When you're about to leave and the mind is already at the destination: say the verse as a shrug. The planner is dismissed; the going runs itself. Feeling-tip: the shoulders drop; the walk starts without a decision.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.5

IV

At Work

at the desk

Yoke the Mind

एवमेव परा पूजा सर्वावस्थासु सर्वदा ।
ऐक्यबुद्धया तु सर्वेशे मनो देवे
नियोजयेत्

evameva parā pūjā sarvāvasthāsu sarvadā | aikyabuddhayā tu sarveśe mano deve niyojayet

just so is the highest worship — in every state, at all times: with a mind of oneness, one should yoke the mind to god as the lord of all.

Yoke the Mind

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.20 · V.20

The instruction after the litany: work is the highest pūjā.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Parā pūjā is ritual re-specified: all states, all times instead of the fixed occasion, and aikyabuddhi — oneness-mindedness — instead of the duality of giver and gift. The verb is niyojayet, yoke: the mind is a draught-animal that must be hitched, and the yoke is identity. The desk becomes the temple by the hitching, not the décor.

HOW TO USE IT

Before opening the laptop: one line, then begin. The test for aikyabuddhi: the boundary of your skin thins. If it sharpens, you're thinking oneness, not yoking it — drop to the breath and restart. Each task is one yoke; re-hitch as often as needed.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.20

Achieve God in Activity

शिवो भूत्वा यजेतेति भक्तो भूत्वेति कथ्यते / त्वम् एव हि वपुः सारं भक्तैर् अद्वयशोधितम्

śivo bhūtvā yajeteti bhakto bhūtveti kathyate / tvam eva hi vapuḥ sāraṃ bhaktair advayaśodhitam

so the devotee is told: become śiva and worship. you yourself are the essence of the body, purified by devotion's non-duality.

Achieve God in Activity

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.14 · 1.14

Lakshmanjoo's work verse: find God in the activity, not by shunning it.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse (śivo bhūtvā yajeti) instructs: become Śiva and worship — and adds that the body's essence (vapuḥ sāraṃ) is refined by bhakti's advaya, non-duality. The gloss from the Academy: achieve God in the activity of the universe, not by shunning it; perceive him in each and every action of life. Work is the field, not the obstacle.

HOW TO USE IT

At the desk, when work feels like a distraction from practice: say it and reclassify. The spreadsheet, the email, the conversation — that is the worship. Feeling-tip: the task itself becomes slightly luminous; do it as offering, not as interruption.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.14

Flowers of Resolve

अर्चयति भैरवं या निश्चयकुसुमैः सुरेशपत्रस्था । प्रणमामि बुद्धिरूपां ब्रह्माणीं तामहं सततम्

arcayati bhairavaṃ yā niścayakusumaiḥ sureśapatrasthā | praṇamāmi buddhirūpāṃ brahmāṇīṃ tāmahaṃ satatam

who worships bhairava with flowers of resolve, standing in the petal of the lord — to intellect-formed brāhmaṇī, to her, i ever bow.

Flowers of Resolve

DEHASTHA V.7 · V.7

Focus as worship: the flower of niścaya, resolve.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Brāhmaṇī — buddhirūpā, the intellect-formed mother — worships Bhairava with niścaya-kusuma, flowers of resolve, standing in the lord's petal. The offering is not a plant but a decision: the settled intention to do this, now. The intellect's own substance becomes the flower.

HOW TO USE IT

At the start of a hard task: name the resolve as a flower — 'this, now' — and place it. One decision, one flower; three tasks, three flowers. Feeling-tip: the mind stops negotiating once the flower is placed. The bow is to the clarity that placed it.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.7

I-Making Flowers

कुरुते

भैरवपूजामनलदलस्थाऽभिमानकुसुमैर्या

। नित्यमहङ्कृतिरूपां वन्दे तां

शाम्भवीमम्बाम्

kurute bhairavapūjāmanaladalasthā'bhimānakusumairyā | nityamahaṅkṛtirūpāṃ vande tāṃ śāmbhavīmambām

who performs bhairava's worship, standing in fire's petal, with flowers of i-making — ever of i-making form, i praise her, the mother śāmbhavī.

I-Making Flowers

DEHASTHA V.8 · V.8

Hand the work-ego over: the ahaṃkāra is the offering.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Śāmbhavī stands in the petal of fire and worships with abhimāna-kusuma — flowers of I-making: the sense of mine and I that is normally the problem. The rite converts the fault into the flower. At work, the 'I' that wants credit is not suppressed — it is picked and placed in the fire.

HOW TO USE IT

When the ego flares mid-task — pride, irritation at the colleague, hunger for recognition: see it as a flower, pick it, place it at the heart's fire. Three flowers are enough. Feeling-tip: relief, like putting down a bag; the fire (warmth at the solar plexus) confirms it.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.8

When Your Form Expands

त्वत्स्वरूपे जृम्भमाणे त्वं चाहं चाखिलं जगत्। जाते तस्य तिरोधाने न त्वं नाहं न वै जगत्

tvatsvarūpe jṛmbhamāṇe tvaṃ cāhaṃ cākhilaṃ jagat | jāte tasya tirodhāne na tvaṃ nāhaṃ na vai jagat

when your own form expands — you and i and the whole world. when its withdrawal is born — neither you, nor i, nor indeed the world.

When Your Form Expands

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.9 · V.9

Expansion and withdrawal: the world is his inhale and exhale.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Two movements: when svarūpa expands (jṛmbhamāṇe), you, I and the whole world appear together; when it withdraws (tirodhāne), none of the three remains. The verse relativises the entire workday — deadlines, colleagues, the self doing them — as one expansion of his form. Not nihilism: the expansion is real, and so is who expands it.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it at the overwhelm point — too much to do, the self tightening. Say it and feel the day as one exhale of a larger form. The overwhelm thins because the 'me' carrying it is part of the expansion, not its owner. Then return to the next small task.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.9

The Senses Turn Back

मनो बुद्धिर् अहं प्राणास् तन्मात्रेन्द्रियजीवनम् । यं दृष्ट्वा विनिवर्तन्ते तम् उपास्यम् उपास्महे

mano buddhir ahaṃ prāṇās tanmātrendriyajīvanam | yaṃ dṛṣṭvā vinivartante tam upāsyam upāsmahe

mind, thought, ego, breaths — the subtle elements, senses and life-principle — when they see the one worth worshipping, they turn back; that, we worship.

THE GUIDE

The Senses Turn Back

SVABODHASIDDHI V.5 · V.5

Not restraint but re-sighting: attention returns when it sees something worth seeing.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The list is the whole apparatus of going-out — manaḥ, buddhi, ahaṃkāra, prāṇas, tanmātras, indriyas, jīva — and the verb is vinivartante: they turn back of themselves, on dṛṣṭvā, seeing. The practice cannot be control but redirecting what they look at. The seen is the object of worship; the seeing is the worship.

HOW TO USE IT

When the mind scatters mid-task: don't pull it back — give it something worth seeing. The breath's origin under the nostrils, or the pulse at the temple. Hold 5–8 seconds. Feeling-tip: 'seeing' means interest, not staring; if the body leans toward the object, you've got it. Three redirects per sitting, no more.

Source: L2-svab-p01.md · v.5

Be Awakened

पूर्वाभावभवक्रिया हि सहसा भावाः सदा ऽस्मिन् भवे मध्याकारविकारसंकरवतां तेषां कुतः सत्यता । निःसत्ये चपले प्रपञ्चनिचये स्वप्नभ्रमे पेशले शङ्कातङ्ककलङ्कयुक्तिकलनातीतः प्रबुद्धो भव

pūrvābhāvabhavakriyā hi sahasā bhāvāḥ sadā 'smin bhave madhyākāravikārasaṃkaravatāṃ teṣāṃ kutaḥ satyatā | niḥsatye capale prapañcanicaye svapnabhrame peśale śaṅkātaṅkakalaṅkayuktikalanātītaḥ prabuddho bhava

earlier states, arising suddenly, always in this world — of mixed middle-form and change — whence their truth? in the untrue, in the shifting heap of the manifest, in dream's charming error: beyond the smear of doubt, fear, stain and clever reasoning — be awakened.

Be Awakened

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.6 · ANU-P06 V.6

For the foggy desk: beyond doubt, fear, stain and reasoning-web — be awakened.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse first dissolves the furniture of the day: the arising states are dream-haze, mixed and truthless. Then the instruction — prabuddho bhava, be awakened — qualified by what to step beyond: śaṅkā (doubt), taṅka (fear), kalaṅka (stain), yukti-kalanā (reasoning-webs). The workday runs on all four; the verse steps over them in one clause.

HOW TO USE IT

When the fog or the imposter-syndrome arrives at the desk: say the last clause aloud — 'beyond doubt, fear, stain and reasoning — be awakened.' Don't analyse the fog; step over it. Feeling-tip: the awakening is not a lightning bolt; it's the refusal to keep chewing the four.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p06 v.6

Born of Your Will

भावानां न समुद्भवो ऽस्ति सहजस् त्वद्भाविता भान्त्य् अमी
निःसत्या अपि सत्यताम् अनुभवभ्रान्त्या भजन्ति क्षणम् ।
त्वत्सङ्कल्पज एष विश्वमहिमा नास्त्य् अस्य जन्मान्यतः तस्मात्
त्वं विभवेन भासि भुवनेष्व् एकोप्य् अनेकात्मकः

bhāvānāṃ na samudbhavo 'sti sahajas tvadbhāvitā bhānty amī niḥsatyā api satyatām anubhavabhrāntyā bhajanti kṣaṇam |
tvatsaṅkalpaja eṣa viśvamahimā nāsty asya janmānyataḥ tasmāt tvaṃ vibhavena bhāsi bhuvaneṣv ekopy anekātmakaḥ

the arising of the states has no separate origin — naturally brightened by your awareness, though untrue they become true for a moment by the error of experience. this universal glory is born of your will: therefore it has no other birth; therefore you shine by your own power in the worlds, one though many-formed.

Born of Your Will

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.7 · ANU-P07 V.7

The work responds to intention: the world's glory is sankalpa-born.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse grants the day's contents a strange status: the arising states (bhāvāḥ) are not truly born — they brighten through your awareness and turn momentarily true by experience's slip. Then the pivot: viśva-mahimā, the world's glory, is tvat-saṅkalpa-ja, born of your will. What you intend into the day is what the day becomes.

HOW TO USE IT

Before the hard task: state the intention once, plainly — this will go well — and remember the verse: the glory is sankalpa-born. Not affirmation-magic; the verse says the world's shine has no other birth. Feeling-tip: intention feels like the day's lighting being adjusted by hand.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p07 v.7

V

Food

before eating

The Meal Offering

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम् ।
ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना ॥

brahmārpaṇaṁ brahma havir brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam / brahmaiva tena gantavyaṁ brahmakarmasamādhinā ॥

the offering is brahman / the oblation is brahman / poured by brahman into the fire of brahman / brahman alone is reached / by one absorbed in the action that is brahman

The Meal Offering

BHAGAVAD GĪTĀ 4.24 (LAKSHMANJOO MEALTIME YAJÑA) · GĪTĀ 4.24

The meal prayer: water in the palm, one verse, and eating becomes worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Lakshmanjoo read brahman throughout as Lord Śiva. Four things are named — the offering, the oblation, the fire, the goal — and all four are the same substance. What you take is offered to Śiva; what you offer is itself Śiva; the stomach is Śiva's residence. The logic collapses the distance between eater, food and eaten into one taste.

HOW TO USE IT

Before the first bite: put a little water in the palm, look at the food, and say the verse once. Then eat as if the meal is being offered into a fire — slowly, without hurry. The feeling to find: gratitude with heat. Nothing extra; the verse does the whole work.

Source: mealtime-yajna.md · Gītā 4.24

Śiva Bows to Śiva

अस्मद्रूप समाविष्टः स्वात्मनात्म निवारणे। शिवः करोतु निजया नमः शक्त्या ततात्मने॥

asmadrūpa samāviṣṭaḥ svātmanātma nivāraṇe / śivaḥ karotu nijayā namaḥ śaktyā tatātmane ॥

śiva, having entered the form that is myself, bows — by his own power — to śiva, for the removal of the obstacle that is himself.

Śiva Bows to Śiva

SOMANANDA, ŚIVADṚṢṬI 7.103 (MEALTIME LORE) · ŚIVADṚṢṬI 7.103 (PROVISIONAL)

The obstacle on the plate is also Śiva. Say it before food.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The whole Trika in one bow: the one who bows, the one bowed to, the obstacle being removed, and the power doing the removing are all Śiva. Nothing is outside the recognition — not even the thing that blocks it. Lakshmanjoo taught this verse alongside the mealtime practice.

HOW TO USE IT

Say it silently as the food arrives. The 'obstacle' can be anything — the craving, the guilt, the person you're eating with. Name it, then let the verse dissolve it. Feeling-tip: the moment of placing should feel like relief, like putting something down.

Source: mealtime-yajna.md · Śivadṛṣṭi 7.103 (provisional)

The Sense-Goddesses Offer Bhairava

आत्मीयविषयभोगैरिन्द्रियदेव्यः सदा हृदम्भोजे। अभिपूजयन्ति यं तं चिन्मयमानन्दभैरवं वन्दे

ātmīyaviṣayabhogairindriyadevyaḥ sadā hṛdambhoje | abhipūjayanti yaṃ taṃ cinmayamānandabhairavaṃ vande

with feasts of their own sense-objects, the sense-goddesses ever worship, in the heart-lotus, him — the consciousness-made bliss-bhairava: i praise.

THE GUIDE

The Sense-Goddesses Offer Bhairava

DEHASTHA V.5 · V.5

Every taste is already a pūjā happening in the heart.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Dehastha inverts the usual charge against the senses: the senses are goddesses (indriya-devyāḥ), and their enjoyment of their objects is continuous worship of the Bhairava made of consciousness. Eating is the oldest form of practice — the offering is already being made in the heart-lotus.

HOW TO USE IT

At the first bite, feel the heart-lotus (just behind the centre of the chest) as the altar and the flavour as the flower landing on it. Three bites only — overdoing it kills the taste. The feeling: gratitude with heat. The sense is honoured as a goddess, not supervised as a thief.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.5

From Eating and Drinking

जग्धिपानकृतोल्लासरसानन्दविजृम्भणात् । भावयेद् भरितावस्थां महानन्दस् ततो भवेत्

jagdhipānakṛtollāsarasānandavijṛmbhaṇāt | bhāvayed bharitāvasthāṃ mahānandas tato bhavet

from the swell of joy made by eating and drinking — from the blooming of bliss-rasa — one should imagine the full state; great bliss then may arise.

From Eating and Drinking

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.72 · V.72

Take the fullness of a meal and turn it into mahānanda.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The dhāraṇā uses a given fact — eating already produces rasa and ullāsa, savour and lift — and makes that the object of bhāvanā: not the taste itself but the state of being filled (bharitāvasthā). Ordinary satiety is the raw material; great bliss the product, if attention stays on fullness instead of sliding to the next want.

HOW TO USE IT

At the meal, not before. Eat to comfortable fullness, then pause with eyes half-open. Take one more spoonful of air, hold, and imagine the fullness radiating from the belly upward — chest, then head. Release. Three rounds. Don't chase ecstasy: the graded signal is that thinking quiets while the body stays warm. If drowsiness comes, stand up.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.72

Food-Offering for the Ever-Content

नित्यतृप्तस्य नैवेद्यं ताम्बूलं च कुतो विभोः ।
प्रदक्षिणमनन्तस्याऽद्वितीयस्यय कुतो नतिः

nityatṛptasya naivedyaṃ tāmbūlaṃ ca kuto vibhoḥ | pradakṣiṇamanantasyā'dvitīyasyaya kuto natiḥ

food-offering for the ever-content, betel for the lord — whence? circumambulation for the endless, obeisance for the non-dual — whence?

Food-Offering for the Ever-Content

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.16 · V.16

The litany asks: what can you offer to one who lacks nothing?

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The four closing rites of pūjā — naivedya (food offering), tāmbūla (betel), pradakṣiṇa (circumambulation), nati (obeisance) — all address a being who could lack something. Śiva lacks nothing. So the offering is not for him but for you: the act of offering is what turns eating into worship, not the food itself.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it as the shrug before a meal: 'what can I offer the one who lacks nothing?' — then offer anyway. The humour is the doctrine. Feeling-tip: lightness, not solemnity. The verse makes the ritual joke that is also the deepest point.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.16

Wherever the Mind Is Content

यत्र यत्र मनस् तुष्टिर् मनस् तत्रैव धारयेत् । तत्र तत्र परानन्दस्वारूपं सम्प्रवर्तते

yatra yatra manas tuṣṭir manas tatraiva dhārayet | tatra tatra parānandasvārūpaṃ sampravartate

wherever the mind is content, there precisely the mind should be held; there, there, the own-form of supreme bliss proceeds to arise.

Wherever the Mind Is Content

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.74 · V.74

Supreme bliss follows attention to contentment, not effort.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

A conditional with a promise: where contentment already exists — any place, object or moment — hold the mind there, and parānanda's own form arises. Bliss is already in motion at the site of contentment; the practice is staying, not seeking. Post-meal fullness is the richest such site of the day.

HOW TO USE IT

After eating, at the most content moment: hold the mind there 30–60 seconds, breathing shallow and slow. Feeling-tip: contentment has a body-map — jaw, shoulders, belly; rest attention there. The sign of success: you stop cataloguing other wants.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.74

Devouring Māyā as Food

मायीयकालनियतिरागाद्याहारतर्पिताः / चरन्ति सुखिनो नाथ भक्तिमन्तो जगत्तटे

māyīyakālaniyatirāgādyāhāratarpitāḥ / caranti sukhino nātha bhaktimanto jagattaṭe

o nātha, your devotees roam happy on the shore of the world, filled and satisfied by consuming māyā, time, fate and desire themselves.

Devouring Māyā as Food

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 15.2 · 15.2

The devotee's menu: māyā, time, niyati, desire — eaten for breakfast.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse is a mealtime paradox: the devotees are tarpitāḥ, sated, by consuming māyīya, kāla, niyati, rāgādi — the very forces that starve everyone else. What the world treats as hunger (desire, fate, time) is their food. They roam happy on the shore of the world, having eaten the ocean.

HOW TO USE IT

Before or after a meal, when desire is loudest: name it as the course — māyā, time, fate, desire — and eat it. The hunger is the menu. Feeling-tip: the wanting transforms into satedness mid-sentence; that flip is the verse working.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 15.2

Satisfied with the Three Worlds

सदा स्रिष्टिविनोदाय सदा स्थितिसुखासिने / सदा त्रिभुवनाहारतृप्ताय स्वामिने नमः

sadā srṣṭivinodāya sadā sthitisukhāsine / sadā tribhuvanāhāratṛptāya svāmine namaḥ

to the master who ever delights in creation, ever sits at ease in preservation, ever is satisfied with the three worlds as food — namas.

Satisfied with the Three Worlds

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 20.9 · 20.9

One bow, five acts, and the universe as his plate.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

One salutation contains the five acts: creation as delight (vinoda), preservation as ease (sukhāsina), dissolution as the three worlds eaten (tribhuvanāhāra-tṛpta) — with grace hidden in 'delight' and 'ease'. If the three worlds are his food, your plate is a course from his meal.

HOW TO USE IT

Say it before eating, after the offering verse: his meal and yours are one table. The five acts run in the background while you chew. Feeling-tip: eating becomes cosmic maintenance — light, unhurried, slightly celebratory.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 20.9

VI

Waiting

in the in-between

I Don't Mind

विषमस्थो ऽपि स्वस्थो ऽपि रुदन्न् अपि हसन्न् अपि / गम्भीरो ऽपि विचित्तो ऽपि भवेयं भक्तितः प्रभो

viṣamastho 'pi svastho 'pi rudann api hasann api / gambhīro 'pi vicitto 'pi bhaveyaṃ bhaktitaḥ prabho

in crisis or at ease, weeping or laughing, grave or unhinged — by devotion, lord, let me be so.

I Don't Mind

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.8 · 16.8

The api-chain refuses resolution: everything is allowed.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse piles up opposites with 'api' (even): viṣama/sthāna (crisis/peace), rudann/hasann (weeping/laughing), gambhīro/vicitta (grave/unhinged). Devotion is not the absence of any of them; it is what holds them. The prayer does not ask for calm — it asks to be devotion through whatever arrives.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it when waiting has turned into agitation — a queue, a delay, a message that won't come. Say it once inwardly. Don't wait for composure: the very mess is the place where devotion can be. Feeling-tip: the shoulders drop half a millimetre; that's the api doing its work.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.8

Methodless Devotion

न ध्यायतो न जपतः स्याद् यस्याविधिपूर्वकम् / एवम् एव शिवभासस् तं नुमो भक्तिशालिनम्

na dhyāyato na japataḥ syād yasyāvidhipūrvakam / evam eva śivabhāsas taṃ numo bhaktiśālinam

i bow to that devotee who is glorified with the devotion of lord śiva and to whom the appearance of lord śiva takes place without conducting meditation or recitation of any kind.

Methodless Devotion

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.1 · 1.1

No method needed — the waiting itself is the devotion.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The opening verse of the Śivastotrāvalī: the devotee to whom Śiva appears without dhyāna or japa (avidhipūrvakam — methodless). The bow is to a state where nothing is being done. Waiting is exactly that state: nothing to do, nowhere to go, and yet not nothing.

HOW TO USE IT

In a queue, on a train, waiting for news: say 'I bow to that devotee' and recognise yourself as the one described. No technique. The waiting is already the practice. Feeling-tip: the hands can rest; the attention does not need to grasp.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.1

In Every Action

अनुभूयासमीशान प्रतिकर्म क्षणात् क्षणम् / भवत्पूजामृतापानमदास्वादमहामुदम्

anubhūyāsamīśāna pratikarma kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam / bhavatpūjāmṛtāpānamadāsvādamahāmudam

o lord, may i experience, moment by moment, in every action, the great joy of drinking the nectar of your worship.

In Every Action

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.19 · 17.19

The in-between moment becomes the practice itself.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Utpaladeva prays for the taste of worship inside every action — not more ritual, but the nectar of pūjā in the ordinary. 'Moment by moment' (kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam) is the whole method: the repeated return of attention. Waiting is full of kṣaṇas — this verse makes them the site of the drink.

HOW TO USE IT

At any transition or pause: say it once, then take one breath as if that breath were the nectar. Don't manufacture joy — notice the small lift that a pause already gives. Three pauses, three sips, and the waiting has changed colour.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.19

No Method

संक्रामो ऽत्र न भावना न च कथायुक्तिर् न चर्चा न च ध्यानं वा न च धारणा न च जपाभ्यासप्रयासो न च । तत् किं नाम सुनिश्चितं वद परं सत्यं च तच्छ्रूयतां न त्यागी न परिग्रही भज सुखं सर्वं यथावस्थितः

saṃkrāmo 'tra na bhāvanā na ca kathāyuktir na carcā na ca dhyānaṃ vā na ca dhāraṇā na ca japābhyāsaprayāso na ca | tat kiṃ nāma suniścitaṃ vada paraṃ satyaṃ ca tacchrūyatāṃ na tyāgī na parigrahī bhaja sukhaṃ sarvaṃ yathāvasthitaḥ

there is no crossing over here — no contemplation, no discussion, no visualization, no steadying, no effort of japa. so what is decided? speak the supreme truth: not a renouncer, not a possessor — enjoy happiness, all of it, staying exactly as you are.

No Method

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.1 · V.1

The anupāya: when every method is denied, waiting is the answer.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse takes away every method — bhāvanā, kathā, carcā, dhyāna, dhāraṇā, japa — and leaves one instruction: stay as you are (yathāvasthitaḥ), enjoy happiness, neither renouncing nor grasping. Waiting is yathāvasthitaḥ in its purest form: nothing to do, nothing to fix.

HOW TO USE IT

When waiting becomes restless, say the verse — or just its last line, 'stay exactly as you are.' The trying to become something is the only distance. Feeling-tip: the restlessness is allowed to sit; you don't argue with it; you just stay.

Source: anuttarastika.md · v.1

Don't Control the Swift Mind

मनसि स्वरसेन यत्र तत्र प्रचरत्य् अप्य् अहम् अस्य गोचरेषु / प्रसृतो ऽप्य् अविलोल एव युष्मत्परिचर्याचतुरः सदा भवेयम्

manasi svarasena yatra tatra pracaraty apy aham asya gocareṣu / prasṛto 'py avilola eva yuṣmatparicaryācaturaḥ sadā bhaveyam

i don't want to control my mind because the mind is so swift, you cannot catch it.

THE GUIDE

Don't Control the Swift Mind

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 12.25 · 12.25

Let the mind roam in the waiting; skill within, not restraint.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Lakshmanjoo's gloss: the mind is too swift to catch, so the verse does not ask for control. The practice is skill within roaming (svarasena pracaraty api) — not catching the mind but being with it as it moves. Waiting is when the mind roams most; this verse blesses the roaming.

HOW TO USE IT

In the waiting, watch the mind go where it goes — plans, memories, fantasies — without steering. The skill is staying with it, not against it. Feeling-tip: a slight amusement at how fast it moves; that amusement is already the 'worship-skilled' state the verse asks for.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 12.25

Abandon Nothing, Grasp Nothing

संसारो ऽस्ति न तत्त्वतस् तनुभृतां बन्धस्य वार्तैव का बन्धो यस्य न जातु तस्य वितथा मुक्तस्य मुक्तिक्रिया । मिथ्यामोहकृद् एष रज्जुभुजगच्छायापिशाचभ्रमो मा किंचित् त्यज मा गृहाण विहर स्वस्थो यथावस्थितः

saṃsāro 'sti na tattvatas tanubhṛtāṃ bandhasya vārtaiva kā bandho yasya na jātu tasya vitathā muktasya muktikriyā | mithyāmohakṛd eṣa rajjubhujagacchāyāpiśācabhramo mā kiṃcit tyaja mā gṛhāṇa vihara svastho yathāvasthitaḥ

saṃsāra is not, in truth, for body-holders — of bondage, what news? bondage never truly is for anyone — so for the free, liberation-rite is false. this error-maker is rope-snake-shadow-ghost-delusion. abandon nothing; grasp nothing; live healthy, staying as you are.

Abandon Nothing, Grasp Nothing

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.2 · ANU-P02 V.2

The waiting instruction par excellence: don't add, don't subtract, just stay.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse dismantles bondage itself — saṃsāra never truly was; the bondage-story is the rope-snake-shadow ghost of māyā. Then the instruction in four beats: mā kiṃcit tyaja (abandon nothing), mā gṛhāṇa (grasp nothing), vihara (live), svastho yathāvasthitaḥ (stay as you are). Waiting is where the mind most wants to add or subtract.

HOW TO USE IT

In the queue, the delay, the silence: say the last line — 'live healthy, staying as you are.' The restlessness wants to grab something or drop something; the verse forbids both. Feeling-tip: the hands open and close once, then rest; the waiting is now the living.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p02 v.2

Things Are Consciousness-Form

रागद्वेषसुखासुखोदयलयाहङ्कारदैन्यादयो ये भावाः प्रविभान्ति विश्ववपुषो भिन्नस्वभावा न ते। व्यक्तिं पश्यसि यस्य यस्य सहसा तत्तत्तदेकात्मतासंविद्रूपम् अवेक्ष्य किं न रमसे तद्भावनानिर्भरः

rāgadveṣasukhāsukhodayalayāhaṅkāradainyādayo ye bhāvāḥ pravibhānti viśvavapuṣo bhinnasvabhāvā na te | vyaktiṃ paśyasi yasya yasya sahasā tattattadekātmatāsaṃvidrūpam avekṣya kiṃ na ramase tadbhāvanānirbharaḥ

passion, aversion, pleasure, displeasure, rise and fall, i-ness, misery and the rest — things shining forth, universe-bodied, are not different-natured. whosever manifestation you suddenly see — having regarded it as one-self-natured consciousness-form — why do you not delight, full of contemplation?

Things Are Consciousness-Form

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.5 · ANU-P05 V.5

Everything that arrives is consciousness-form: so why not delight?

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse lists what a waiting mind churns through — rāga, dveṣa, sukha, aśukha, rise, fall, ahaṃkāra, misery — and denies them separate nature: they are viśva-vapuṣa, bodying the universe, shining as one-self-natured consciousness-form. The instruction is ramase: delight, full of that contemplation. Boredom is a failure of seeing, not of circumstance.

HOW TO USE IT

When the waiting mind churns: pick whatever is arising — irritation, boredom — and label it 'consciousness-form.' Then the verse's question stands: why not delight? Feeling-tip: the irritation, seen as form, is already interesting; delight arrives sideways.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p05 v.5

Two Classes of People

न किञ्चिद् एव लोकानां भवदावरणं प्रति यत् किं चिद् एव भूतानां

na kiñcid eva lokānāṃ bhavadāvaraṇaṃ prati yat kiṃ cid eva bhūtānāṃ

there are two classes found in this universe: one class is of ordinary people, and another are those who are thy devotees.

Two Classes of People

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.1 · 16.1

In the queue: two kinds of people, and you know which you are.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse is a quiet census — only two classes, ordinary folk and bhaktas — with no third category of the merely interested. It's a wry re-classification of the crowd: everyone waiting with you belongs to one of two groups, and the difference isn't visible from the outside. The devotee smiles at the census.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it in any crowd — the queue, the train, the meeting. Run the census once: two classes. Then check which one is noticing the census. Feeling-tip: a small private smile; nobody can tell from the outside which class you're in — that's the point.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.1

VII

When You Are Negative

fear · doubt · grief

I Never Fear

इत्थम्

उपोढभवन्मयसंविद्दीधितिदारितभूरितमिस्रः ।

मृत्युयमान्तककर्मपिशाचैर् नाथ नमोऽस्तु न जातु

बिभेमि

ittham upoḍhabhavanmayasaṃviddīdhitidāritabhūritamisraḥ | mṛtyuyamāntakakarmapiśācair nātha namo'stu na jātu bibhemi

thus, with the great darkness torn open by the rays of the consciousness become you — lord, namas; i never fear, not from death, from yama, from the ender, from the ghosts of karma.

I Never Fear

ABHINAVAGUPTA, BHAIRAVASTAVA 5 · BH-P05

Fearlessness as salutation, not as courage.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Awareness has already torn the darkness; what remains is not courage but salutation. The devotee still names death's ministers — Mṛtyu, Yama, the ender, the karma-ghosts — and bows to them, because they too are Śiva's play. 'I never fear' is the natural temperature of recognition.

HOW TO USE IT

Recite when fear arrives — not to banish it but to salute it. The fear is named, bowed to, and left standing. Feeling-tip: the chest opens rather than tightens; the bow is physical as well as verbal. Do it at night, or in the moment before the difficult thing.

Source: bhairavastava.md · bh-p05

No Fear-Talk

स्वात्मनि विश्वगये त्वयि नाथे तेन न संसृतिभीतिकथास्ति । सत्स्व् अपि दुर्धरदुःखविमोहत्रासविधायिषु कर्मगणेषु

svātmani viśvagaye tvayi nāthe tena na saṃsṛtibhītikathāsti | satsv api durdharaduḥkhavimohatrāsavidhāyiṣu karmagaṇeṣu

with you as lord, all-pervading in own self — therefore no talk of transmigration-fear. even though hard-to-bear suffering, delusion, terror-causing karma-hosts are present.

No Fear-Talk

ABHINAVAGUPTA, BHAIRAVASTAVA 3 · BH-P03

The suffering is conceded; the fear-talk is not.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse does not deny suffering — it concedes the karma-hosts (durdharaduḥkhavimohatrāsavidhāyiṣu) — but denies the fear of saṃsāra, because the Lord is all-pervading in the self. Suffering can be present without being feared; the fear-talk is what stops.

HOW TO USE IT

When negative, say it and let the concession stand: yes, this is hard; and the fear of it is separate from the pain itself. The verse splits them. Feeling-tip: the pain stays, the story about the pain thins. That thinning is the verse working.

Source: bhairavastava.md · bh-p03

The Cloud Lifts

गुरोर्वाक्याद्युक्ति-प्रचय-रचन-उन्मार्जन-वशात्समाश्वासाच्छास्त्रं
प्रति समुचितादपि कथितम्। विलीने शङ्काभ्रे
हृदयगगनोद्भासिमहसः प्रभोः सूर्यस्येव स्पृशतु चरणान्
ध्वान्तजयिनः

gurorvākyādyukti-pracaya-racana-unmārjana-vaśātsamāśvāsācchāstraṃ prati samucitādapi kathitam | vilīne śaṅkābhre hṛdayagaganodbhāsimahasaḥ prabhoḥ sūryasyeva spṛśatu caraṇān dhvāntajayinaḥ

from the guru's word — by the force that wipes away the fabric of heaped-up reasonings — and from the assurance told, fittingly, out of regard for scripture: when the cloud of doubt has dissolved, let me touch the feet of the lord, whose splendor shines in the sky of the heart — like the sun, the conqueror of darkness.

The Cloud Lifts

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 4 · PAN-P04

For doubt: the cloud dissolves, the sun is already there.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse traces doubt to 'heaped-up reasonings' (pracaya-racana) that the guru's word wipes away, and promises that when the cloud of doubt (śaṅkābhra) dissolves, the feet of the sun-like Lord — shining in the heart-sky — become touchable. Doubt is weather, not the sky.

HOW TO USE IT

When doubt is heavy, say it and picture the cloud as literal weather over the heart. The sun is not summoned; it is uncovered. Feeling-tip: the image of touching the feet — a small act of trust — is the whole practice. Repeat the last line as a refrain.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p04

Saṃsāra and Beyond

संसारैकनिमित्ताय संसारैकविरोधिने / नमः सम्सारूपाय निःसंसाराय शम्भवे

saṃsāraikanimittāya saṃsāraikavirodhine / namaḥ samsārarūpāya niḥsaṃsārāya śambhave

to the one who is the sole cause of saṃsāra and the sole opponent of saṃsāra; to śambhu, who is the form of saṃsāra and is beyond saṃsāra, namas.

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Saṃsāra and Beyond

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.8 · 2.8

No enemy outside: bondage and release are the same Lord.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

A paradox of the recognition: the one who causes saṃsāra also destroys it; Śambhu is its form and also beyond it. There is no enemy to defeat outside the self. When you feel negative about the world, this verse says: the world's very form is Śambhu.

HOW TO USE IT

When the world feels like the problem, say it. The split between 'spiritual' and 'worldly' is the only saṃsāra. Feeling-tip: the irritation with the world softens into recognition; the same world, seen as his form, is no longer an attack.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.8

The Knife That Cuts the Knot

ममाहम् इति
हृद्ग्रन्थिच्छेदनैककृपाणिकाम् ।
स्पन्दास्पन्दकृतग्रासां नौम्य् अहं
शुद्धसंविदम्

mamāham iti hṛdgranthicchedanaikakṛpāṇikām | spandāspandakṛtagrāsāṃ naumy ahaṃ śuddhasaṃvidam

i bow — i — to pure awareness: the knife that alone cuts the heart's knot of 'mine' and 'i', the one that has swallowed both the throb and its stillness.

THE GUIDE

The Knife That Cuts the Knot

SVABODHASIDDHI V.6 · V.6

For guilt and possessiveness: one cut, and the knot is gone.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The knot (granthi) is mamāham — 'mine' and 'I', two threads. The instrument is a kṛpāṇa, a knife, and only one does it: pure awareness. And the knower's own domain — throb and stillness — has already been swallowed by that knife. 'I bow — I' stages the surrender: the pronoun survives long enough to bow, then is cut too.

HOW TO USE IT

Recite with a hand flat over the sternum. Weight the first aham: feel where your 'I' sits in the body, and on 'naumy ahaṃ' press gently and let that place soften. The image is a blade, but the feeling is a release of grip, not a strike — knots untie. Fastest on small knots (a slighted email), slower on old ones.

Source: L2-svab-p01.md · v.6

Turn Not This Wrathful Gaze

अन्तक मां प्रति मा दृशम् एनां क्रोधकरालतां विनिधेहि । शङ्करसेवनचिन्तनधीरो भीषणभैरवशक्तिमयो ऽस्मि

antaka māṃ prati mā dṛśam enāṃ krodhakarālatāṃ vinidhehi | śaṅkarasevanacintanadhīro bhīṣaṇabhairavaśaktimayo 'smi

o ender, turn not toward me this most wrathful-terrible gaze. by śaṅkara-service, contemplation-firm, i am terrifying-bhairava-power-filled.

THE GUIDE

Turn Not This Wrathful Gaze

ABHINAVAGUPTA, BHAIRAVASTAVA 4 · BH-P04

Facing wrath — his or theirs — without flinching.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The devotee does not ask the wrath away; he asks that it not be aimed at him, and answers with his own composition: service and firm contemplation have made him bhīṣaṇa-bhairava-śakti-maya, filled with the terrifying power itself. You cannot be burned by the fire you are made of. The gaze turns aside because there is no separate target left.

HOW TO USE IT

When facing anger — a boss, a partner, your own — say it with the hand on the sternum. Don't argue with the wrath; declare your composition. Feeling-tip: you become too made-of-it to be its victim; the gaze slides off because the target dissolved.

Source: bhairavastava.md · bh-p04

Smasher of the Fantasy-Net

निरस्तकल्पनाजालविकल्पौघविघातिने । नमो ऽस्तु परमानन्दपदातीताय शम्भवे

nirastakalpanājālavikalpaughavighātine | namo 'stu paramānandapadātītāya śambhave

bow, let there be bow, to śambhu — smasher of the net of fancies and their floods, standing past even the highest bliss.

Smasher of the Fantasy-Net

SVABODHASIDDHI V.3 · V.3

For the spiralling mind: he breaks the net, not the thinker.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse names the negative state precisely: kalpanā-jāla, a net of fancies, and vikalpa-ogha, floods of alternatives — the what-if ocean. Śambhu's action is aighātine, a smashing, and his position is beyond even paramānanda, so the rescue doesn't depend on your mood reaching bliss first. The net breaks from outside the net.

HOW TO USE IT

When the fantasy-net is weaving — replaying, catastrophising: say the verse as a command addressed to Śambhu, not a request to yourself. You cannot untangle from inside the tangle; you can call the smasher. Feeling-tip: one thread snaps; the flood slows by a notch.

Source: L2-svab-p01.md · v.3

Darkness upon Darkness

तिमिराद् अपि तिमिरम् इदं ग.ङ्स्योपरि महान् अयं स्फोटः । यद् अनात्मन्य् अपि देहप्राणदाव् आत्ममानित्वम्

timirād api timiram idaṃ ga.ṅdasyopari mahān ayaṃ sphoṭaḥ | yad anātmany api dehaprāṇadāv ātmamānitvam

darkness upon darkness — a great burst upon the cheek: taking body, breath and the rest, non-selves, for self.

Darkness upon Darkness

PARAMĀRTHASĀRA V.31 · V.31

The deepest negative state has a diagnosis: wrong address.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse grades the error: worse than darkness (timirād api timiram) is the great sphoṭa, the burst — taking the body-breath complex, which is not-self, for the self. Self-loathing, shame, the contracted I — all of it is ātma-mānitva, self-identification, applied to non-selves. The negativity isn't about you; it's about an address mix-up.

HOW TO USE IT

When the self-hatred arrives: name it as the verse does — darkness upon darkness, an address error. The body-breath is being mistaken for you. Feeling-tip: the sting loses its target when you see it's aimed at the wrong house; the real self was never on that street.

Source: L2-param-p04.md · v.31

VIII

When You Are Positive

rejoice · devote

Victory at the Door

महेश त्वद्द्वारि स्फुरतु रुचिरा वाग् अतितरां मम एषा निर्दोषं
जय जय महेशेति सततम्। शिवा सैषा वाणी भवतु शिवदा
मह्यम् अनिशं महेशनाथं मां शरणद सनाथं कुरु विभो

maheśa tvaddvāri sphuratu rucirā vāg atitarāṃ mama eṣā nirdoṣaṃ jaya jaya maheśeti satatam | śivā saiṣā vāṇī bhavatu śivadā mahyam aniśaṃ maheśanāthaṃ māṃ śaraṇada sanāthaṃ kuru vibho

o maheśa, may this lovely speech of mine flash forth at your door, faultlessly, again and again: victory, victory to maheśa! may this auspicious speech be giver of bliss to me, unceasingly. o lord, o giver of refuge, make me — whose protector is maheśanātha — to have a protector.

Victory at the Door

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 2 · PAN-P02

The prayer of rejoicing: only speech to offer, and it flashes at the door.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The devotee has nothing but speech, and asks that it flash at the Lord's door, faultless, repeating 'victory, victory to Maheśa'. Then the real request: make me to have a protector. Śaraṇāgati is not becoming strong but being held — and the rejoicing is the holding already underway.

HOW TO USE IT

When something good has happened — or when you want to rejoice anyway — say it aloud if possible. The repetition of 'jaya jaya maheśa' is the celebration. Feeling-tip: the smile arrives before the words; let it. The verse is permission to be happy in his name.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p02

Mad with the Nectar of Devotion

जयन्ति भक्तिपीयूषरसासववरोन्मदाः / अद्वितीया अपि सदा त्वद्वितीया अपि प्रभो

jayanti bhaktipīyūṣarasāsavavaronmadāḥ / advitīyā api sadā tvaddvitīyā api prabho

victory to those who have become mad by taking the nectarized liquor of thy devotion — those who, though alone, are always with thee, though without a second.

Mad with the Nectar of Devotion

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.5 · 1.5

Devotion as intoxication: the positive state has a name.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse names the ones who have drunk bhakti-rasa (devotion's nectar) and gone mad (unmadāḥ) — and their sign: though apparently alone, they are always with him; though without a second, they are not lonely. The 'madness' is the joy that comes from drinking the right thing.

HOW TO USE IT

When the joy is already there, say it and name it: this is the nectar. Don't analyse the joy; toast it. Feeling-tip: the slight giddiness the verse describes is the actual state — lean into it, don't explain it to anyone.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.5

The Stone Pillar Worships

भक्तिकण्डूसम् उल्लासावसरे परमेश्वर / महानिकषपाषाणस्थूणा पूजैव जायते

bhaktikaṇḍūsam ullāsāvasare parameśvara / mahānikaṣapāṣāṇasthūṇā pūjaiva jāyate

o lord śiva, when a devotee of thee has created this itching sensation of bhakti (devotion), and that itching won't be removed until you are there, you are present. your main presence will remove that itching sensation.

The Stone Pillar Worships

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 20.8 · 20.8

When devotion itches, even a stone pillar becomes worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse takes the itch of bhakti (bhaktikaṇḍū) — the restless longing — and says that when it arises, even a mahānikaṣapāṣāṇasthūṇa, a great stone pillar, becomes pūjā, worship. The longing itself is the worship; you don't need the right posture or place.

HOW TO USE IT

When the positive urge to connect arrives — the itch — don't damp it. Say this and let the itch be the offering. The feeling: a restless sweetness that doesn't need a destination. Even waiting with the itch is already the pillar being worshipped.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 20.8

He Alone Wins

स जयति शिव एकः स्पन्दवान्
स्वप्रतिष्ठः योऽन्तर्वक्त्रं रसयति

sa jayati śiva ekaḥ spandavān svapratiṣṭhaḥ yo'ntarvaktraṃ rasayati

he alone wins — śiva, possessor of the pulse, self-established, who makes the inner face taste.

He Alone Wins

KṢEMARĀJA, SPANDASANDOHA 1 · V.1

A one-line victory song for the moment everything is right.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Kṣemarāja's condensation of the Spandakārikā: Śiva alone wins — he who possesses the pulse (spanda), is self-established, and makes the inner face taste. 'The inner face' is attention turned back on itself; to taste it is the whole of the practice. The verse is already in the register of victory.

HOW TO USE IT

Say it when the recognition lands — when you see, when you taste, when the pulse is obvious. It's a salute, not a request. Feeling-tip: the slight pride in 'he alone wins' is allowed; it's his victory you're naming, and yours for seeing it.

Source: spandasandoha.md · v.1

The Wheel of Powers

यस्योन्मेषनिमेषाभ्यां जगतः प्रलयोदयौ । तं शक्तिचक्रविभवप्रभवं शङ्करं स्तुमः

yasyonmeṣanimeṣābhyāṃ jagataḥ pralayodayau | taṃ śakticakravibhavaprabhavaṃ śaṅkaraṃ stumaḥ

to him by whose opening and closing the world dissolves and arises — to śaṅkara, source of the glory of the wheel of powers, we sing.

The Wheel of Powers

VASUGUPTA, SPANDAKĀRIKĀ 1.1 · SPANDAKĀRIKĀ 1.1

The opening hymn: the world blinks, and we sing to the one who blinks it.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The Spandakārikā opens with a hymn to the pulse: by the Lord's opening and closing (onmeṣa-nimeṣa — his blink) the world dissolves and arises. The 'wheel of powers' is the circle of śaktis through which consciousness manifests. To sing is to join the pulse rather than resist it.

HOW TO USE IT

Recite when the world feels vivid — when colours are sharp, when music lands, when the pulse is obvious. It's a song of participation. Feeling-tip: blink with the verse; the world dissolving and arising on each blink is literal enough.

Source: spanda.md · Spandakārikā 1.1

Enjoy Lordhood

यत् सत्यं यद् असत्यम् अल्पबहुलं नित्यं न नित्यं च यत् यन्
मायामलिनं यद् आत्मविमलं चिद्दर्पणे राजते । तत् सर्वं
स्वविमर्शसंविदुदयाद् रूपप्रकाशात्मकं ज्ञात्वा
स्वानुभवाधिरूढमहिमा विश्वेश्वरत्वं भज

yat satyaṁ yad asatyam alpabahulaṁ nityaṁ na nityaṁ ca yat yan māyāmalinaṁ yad ātmavimalaṁ ciddarpaṇe rājate | tat sarvaṁ svavimarśasaṁvidudayād rūpaprakāśātmakaṁ jñātvā svānubhavādhirūḍhamahimā viśveśvaratvaṁ bhaja

whatever is real and whatever is unreal, little or much, eternal or not; whatever shines stained by māyā or pure as the self in the mirror of consciousness — know it all to be the light of form arising from one's own self-awareness; then, with a glory mounted on your own experience, enjoy the lordhood of the universe.

Enjoy Lordhood

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.8 · ANU-P08 V.8

The last verse of the Anuttarāṣṭikā: enjoy Lordhood.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse gathers the whole world — real, unreal, stained, pure — into the mirror of consciousness as the light of form arising from one's own awareness. Then the instruction: bhaja viśveśvaratvam, enjoy the Lordhood of the universe. Lordhood is not power over things; it is the taste of seeing them as yourself. This is rejoicing as a metaphysical claim.

HOW TO USE IT

When things are going well — or when you want to rejoice anyway: say the last clause aloud. Lordhood is a tasting, not a trophy. Feeling-tip: the chest opens, the world turns slightly luminous; that luminance is svānubhavādhirūḍha, mounted on your own experience. Don't explain it to anyone.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p08 v.8

The Play of Dissolution

सतो विनाशसम्बन्धान् मत्परं निखिलं मृषा / एवमेवोद्यते नाथ त्वया संहारलीलया

sato vināśasambandhān matparaṃ nikhilaṃ mṛṣā / evamevodyate nātha tvayā saṃhāralīlayā

what is not of the real is held as mine — thus, o lord, you raise the play of dissolution. everything not in eternal being is mine: thus your saṃhāra-līlā is raised.

The Play of Dissolution

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 20.18 · 20.18

When things fall apart: it's a lecture, not a loss — his līlā.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Lakshmanjoo's gloss: when Śiva destroys the universe he doesn't actually destroy it — he teaches; the teaching comes out of his being. The verse reads destruction as saṃhāra-līlā, play. What dissolves was never of the real (sataḥ vināśa-sambandhān); the falling-apart is the Lord's pedagogy, and everything is divine to those who see it.

HOW TO USE IT

When something ends — a job, a phase, a plan: say it as the verse does. This is the play of dissolution; he's lecturing, not punishing. Feeling-tip: the grief stays but stops being an accident; the graveyard dance in the lore is the same move. Watch the end as his teaching.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 20.18

The Sweet Festival

अहो को ऽपि जयत्य् एष स्वादुः पूजामहोत्सवः / यतो ऽमृतरसास्वादम् अश्रूण्य् अपि ददत्य् अलम्

aho ko 'pi jayaty eṣa svāduḥ pūjāmahotsavaḥ / yato 'mṛtarasāsvādam aśrūṇy api dadaty alam

oho! how wonderful — this unique festival of your worship, so sweet, gladdening all round: by it even tears come to taste the nectar.

The Sweet Festival

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.1 · 17.1

The pūjā as festival: even tears taste nectar.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse calls the worship a pūjā-mahotsava, a great festival, svādu, sweet — and makes a precise claim: by its amṛta-rasa-āsvādana, even tears (aśrūṇi) are given the nectar's taste. Sadness is not excluded from the celebration; it is recruited. The festival runs on whatever the day supplies.

HOW TO USE IT

On a good day: name it the festival — you're inside it. On a day that brings tears: the verse promises they taste of nectar; let them. Feeling-tip: joy and grief on the same tongue — that doubleness is the mahotsava, not a bug in it.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.1

IX

Evening / Sleep

wind down · lights out

From Your Waking, His Waking

त्वत्प्रबोधात् प्रबोधोऽस्य त्वन्निद्रातो लयोऽस्य यत् ।
अतस्त्वदात्मकं सर्वं विश्व सदसदात्मकम्

tvatprabodhāt prabodho'sya tvannidrāto layo'sya yat | atastvadātmakaṃ sarvaṃ viśva sadasadātmakam

from your waking comes his waking; from your sleep comes his merging. hence all is of your nature — the world, both real and unreal.

THE GUIDE

From Your Waking, His Waking

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.11 · V.11

Your sleep does not stop the world — it feeds it.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Two transfers: prabodha (waking) passes from you to him, laya (dissolution) from his sleep to the world. Because his waking enlivens the world and his sleep dissolves it, everything is tvad-ātmaka, of your nature. Sleep is not the end of practice but its most global act: when you sleep you participate in his laya.

HOW TO USE IT

Last line of the day. Lie down and take one awake minute: you are about to do what he does at night. Don't stay awake doing this — fall asleep inside the thought. Feeling-tip: as the eyes close, feel the day's edges get soft, 'unreal' — that softening is sadasadātmakam. If anxious at night, this dissolves the day rather than reviewing it.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.11

In Sleep, When the Outer Range Perished

अनागतायां निद्रायाम् प्रणष्टे बाह्यगोचरे । सावस्था मनसा गम्या परा देवी प्रकाशते

anāgatāyāṃ nidrāyām praṇaṣṭe bāhyagocare | sāvasthā manasā gamyā parā devī prakāśate

in the not-yet-come sleep, when the outer range has perished — that state, to be gone to by mind, the supreme goddess shines forth.

In Sleep, When the Outer Range Perished

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.75 · V.75

The instruction for the moment before sleep: go there by mind.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Three conditions: sleep that has not yet arrived; once the outer field has died. In that gap, to be gone to by mind, parā devī, the supreme Goddess, shines — not is-made. The verse locates practice in the dying of the outer senses, where consciousness is neither awake nor asleep, and names what appears there as Śakti herself.

HOW TO USE IT

At lights-out, on your back, one hand on the belly. Wait for the outer field to fade — sounds go dull, images slow. Then instead of following sleep passively, send the mind as an arrow to the heart-centre, once. Then release. The Goddess-feel is a hum or warmth behind the chest; if images swarm you have grasped — release and let the hum carry. Single-shot: no repetitions.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.75

Gaze Down, Mind Unsupported

स्थूलरूपस्य भावस्य स्तब्धां दृष्टिं निपात्य च। अचिरेण निराधारं मनः कृत्वा शिवं व्रजेत्

sthūlarūpasya bhāvasya stabdhāṃ dṛṣṭiṃ nipātya ca | acireṇa nirādhāraṃ manaḥ kṛtvā śivaṃ vrajet

of the gross-formed state — fixing the gaze downward, and swiftly: making the mind unsupported, one may go to śiva.

Gaze Down, Mind Unsupported

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.80 · V.80

The last practice before sleep: eyes down, mind unsupported, go.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The bhāva is the gross — the day's residue, the body's weight; the gaze is set firm and lowered; the mind is made nirādhāra, without support: no image, no thought to rest on. Three conditions, one result — śivaṃ vrajet, one may go to Śiva. 'Go' is not travel; it is sleep without a holder.

HOW TO USE IT

Lie down. Eyes half-open, lowered toward the pillow, then closed once the gaze has found its floor. Remove the mind's supports one by one: drop the plan for tomorrow, drop the commentary on the day, drop even the wish to sleep. What's left is a warm weight behind the sternum with no object — that is nirādhāra. If the mind grabs a support, note 'support' and set it down.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.80

Creating, Keeping, Dissolving

सृष्टिस्थितिसंहारा जाग्रत्स्वप्नौ सुषुप्तम् इति तस्मिन्। भान्ति तुरीये धामनि तथापि तैर् नावृतं भाति

sṛṣṭisthitisaṃhārā jāgratsvapnau suṣuptam iti tasmin | bhānti turīye dhāmani tathāpi tair nāvṛtaṃ bhāti

creating, keeping, dissolving; waking, dreaming, deep sleep — these shine in him, in the fourth abode; and unveiled he shines, not covered by them.

Creating, Keeping, Dissolving

PARAMĀRTHASĀRA V.34 · V.34

The states are lights in a room; the room is not covered by them.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The macro (creation, maintenance, dissolution) is mapped onto the micro (the three states), both placed in turīya, the fourth abode. The load-bearing clause: tathāpi tair nāvṛtam — yet not veiled by them. Turīya is not a fourth experience but what remains unveiled while the others shine.

HOW TO USE IT

A sleep primer, slowly: the three acts — pause — the three states — pause — then hold nāvṛtam (unveiled) as the last word you hear. The feeling: a screen behind the mind's pictures that stays clear while pictures change. Don't try to enter turya; the verse points at what is not covered. Sleep then arrives without touching the unveiled.

Source: L2-param-p04.md · v.34

At Your Cool Feet

अशेषविषयाशून्यश्रीसमाश्लेषसुस्थितः / शयीयम् इव शीताङ्घ्रिकुशेशययुगे कदा

aśeṣaviṣayāśūnyaśrīsamāśleṣasusthitaḥ / śayīyam iva śītāṅghrikuśeśayayuge kadā

when will i lie down — free of every object, settled in the embrace of undiminished glory — at your two cool lotus feet?

At Your Cool Feet

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.14 · 9.14

The sleep prayer: the cool feet are the peace after the fever of wanting.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Utpaladeva asks when he will lie down free of every object (aśeṣaviṣaya — no grasping left), settled in undiminished glory (aśūnya śrī), at the two cool lotus feet (śītāṅghri-kuśeśaya). 'Free of every object' is not blankness but the rest that remains when the mind stops reaching. The cool feet are the peace of Śiva.

HOW TO USE IT

In bed. Say it once, then let the image of the two cool feet form under the mind's eye — no details needed, just the coolness. The feeling to find: the fever of the day dropping. If the mind races, return to the coolness, not the words.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.14

Bliss Is the Forgotten Treasure

आनन्दो ऽत्र न वित्तमध्यमदवन् नैवाङ्गनासङ्गवत्
दीपार्केन्दुकृतप्रभाप्रकरवन् नैव प्रकाशोदयः । हर्षः
संभृतभेदमुक्तिसुखभूर् भारावतारोपमः सर्वाद्वैतपदस्य
विस्मृतनिधेः प्राप्तिः प्रकाशोदयः

ānando 'tra na vittamadhyamadavan naivāṅganāsaṅgavat dīpārkendukṛtaprabhāprakaravan naiva prakāśodayaḥ | harṣaḥ saṃbhṛtabhedamuktisukhabhūr bhārāvatāropamaḥ sarvādvaitapadasya vismṛtanidheḥ prāptiḥ prakāśodayaḥ

bliss here is not wealth-middle-intoxication, nor like enjoying women, nor lamp-sun-moon-made splendour-multitude — and not the light-rise either. joy with gathered-difference-liberation-bliss-ground, like burden-lowering, is the attainment of the forgotten treasure of the all-nonduality state — the light-rise.

Bliss Is the Forgotten Treasure

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.4 · ANU-P04 V.4

The sleep verse: bliss as burden-lowering, the forgotten treasure.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse defines bliss by negation — not wealth-drunkenness, not sensual pleasure, not spectacle-light — then gives the positive: harṣa like bhārāvatāra, the lowering of a burden, is the prāpti of vismṛta-nidhi, the forgotten treasure of the non-dual state. Falling into sleep is that burden-lowering: the day's weight set down at the door.

HOW TO USE IT

In bed, say it and feel the day's weight as the literal bhāra being lowered. Bliss here is not an event but an unloading. Feeling-tip: the shoulders drop a centimetre deeper each line; by the last line the bed has the treasure under it.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p04 v.4

Meditate the Bliss, Dissolve

आनन्दे महति प्राप्ते दृष्टे वा बान्धवे चिरात् ।
आनन्दम् उद्गतं ध्यात्वा तल्लयस् तन्मना भवेत्

ānande mahati prāpte dṛṣṭe vā bāndhave cirāt | ānandam udgataṃ dhyātvā tallayas tanmanā bhavet

in joy, in greatness, when it is won — seen or a kinsman long after: bliss risen, having meditated it, dissolved in that — of that mind may be.

THE GUIDE

Meditate the Bliss, Dissolve

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.71 · V.71

The last thought before sleep: bliss, then dissolve into it.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The dhāraṇā takes any big joy — won, seen, or a beloved met after long — lets the ānanda rise (udgataṃ), meditates it, and asks the mind to become tan-maya, dissolved in that. The instruction for the transition into sleep: pick the day's brightest moment, magnify it, and let consciousness dissolve into its own brightness.

HOW TO USE IT

Lights out: choose today's best moment — a laugh, a view, a kindness. Hold it until the joy rises, then stop holding; dissolve. The verse's grammar is dhyātvā… tallayaḥ — meditate, then dissolve. Feeling-tip: sleep takes you the way water takes a sugar cube.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.71

Gaze in the Dappled Sky

तेजसा सूर्यदीपादेर् आकाशे शबलीकृते । दृष्टिर् निवेश्या तत्रैव स्वात्मरूपम् प्रकाशते

tejasā sūryadīpāder ākāśe śabalīkṛte | dṛṣṭir niveśyā tatraiva svātmarūpam prakāśate

by the brilliance of sun, lamp and such, in the sky made dappled: gaze fixed right there — one's own self-form shines forth.

Gaze in the Dappled Sky

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.76 · V.76

The lamp-gaze: fix on the after-image, and the self appears.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

A physiological dhāraṇā: look at a light (sun, lamp), the visual field goes śabala, dappled with after-images; fix the gaze in that dappled sky (ākāśa) and svātma-rūpa, one's own self-form, shines forth there. The technique uses the eye's own residue as the screen on which the self displays.

HOW TO USE IT

Before sleep, on your back: glance at the lamp for a second, close the eyes, and watch the dappled field behind the lids. Rest the gaze there without straining. The patches of light are the sky; the self-form shines in them. Feeling-tip: don't hunt an image — the after-glow is enough; let it carry you down.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.76

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

peace, peace, peace

PRACTICAL PRAYERS

The day, complete From the first light to the last breath, the day is one sequence of recognitions: you wake into his waking, wash a body that is his temple, walk out among his forms, work as his yoke, eat his offering, wait in his pace, meet your negatives as his play, rejoice in his victory, and hand the night back to his sleep. The prayers are small; the day is the practice.

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